

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2022-23



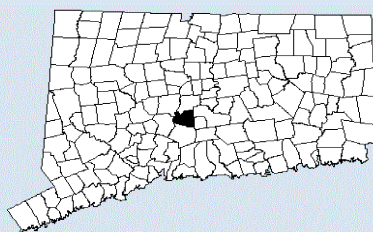
Meriden School District

Dr. Mark Benigni, Superintendent • 203-630-4171 • <http://www.meridenk12.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	31
Enrollment	8,630
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$16,031
Total Expenditures ¹	\$143,529,042

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2021-22 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2022-23 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2022 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	4,178	48.4	48.4
Male	4,441	51.5	51.5
Non-Binary	11	0.1	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	167	1.9	5.2
Black or African American	1,003	11.6	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5,200	60.3	30.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	366	4.2	4.5
White	1,880	21.8	47.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	1,507	17.5	9.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	6,656	77.1	42.4
Students with Disabilities ³	1,795	20.8	17.1

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	1,114	26.6	*	*
Male	1,229	28.3	619	13.1
Non-Binary	6	*	*	*
Black or African American	263	26.5	186	17.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,612	31.1	658	11.8
White	373	20.4	148	7.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	445	28.3	133	7.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,085	31.2	916	12.7
Students with Disabilities	687	40.5	293	14.0
District	2,349	27.5	1,033	11.3
State		20.0		7

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 4,385

Number of school-based arrests: 14

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Meriden School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	503.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	40.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	96.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	153.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	14.8
School Level	39.5
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.5
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	34.2
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	57.6
School Nurses	14.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	576.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	3	0.4	0.1
Asian	4	0.5	1.3
Black or African American	24	3.2	4.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	64	8.5	4.9
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	6	0.8	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.1	0.2
White	647	86.4	88.7

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2021-22

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	11.4	13.2

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	83	91.2	83	96.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	288	89.4	330	97.3
White	136	95.8	152	99.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	67	76.1	68	89.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	419	93.3	454	98.5
Students with Disabilities	110	94.0	144	98.0
District	542	91.9	603	97.9
State		86.5		94.2

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	128	53.1
Emotional Disability	63	36.6
Intellectual Disability	30	26.3
Learning Disability	558	90.9
Other Health Impairment	226	73.1
Other Disabilities	13	21.3
Speech/Language Impairment	114	96.6
District	1,132	69.5
State		68.6

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	275	3.1	2.4
Emotional Disability	174	2.0	1.0
Intellectual Disability	114	1.3	0.6
Learning Disability	615	7.0	6.3
Other Health Impairment	313	3.5	3.4
Other Disabilities	119	1.3	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	128	1.5	1.9
All Disabilities	1,738	19.7	16.7

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	80	4.6	8.1
Private Schools or Other Settings	57	3.3	4.7

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2021-22

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$92,962,927	\$10,383	\$12,671
Support services - students	\$10,139,676	\$1,196	\$1,558
Support services - instruction	\$742,470	\$88	\$837
Support services - general administration	\$1,784,147	\$211	\$463
Support services - school based administration	\$6,713,575	\$792	\$1,133
Central and other support services	\$4,644,888	\$548	\$716
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$17,670,519	\$2,085	\$1,893
Student transportation services	\$7,227,090	\$1,245	\$1,464
Food services	\$294,464	\$35	\$5
Enterprise operations	\$1,349,286	\$159	\$186
Total	\$143,529,042	\$16,031	\$20,165

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2021-22

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$7,434,392	22.0	29.0
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,779,307	8.2	10.6
Other Salaries	\$6,207,261	18.3	10.1
Employee Benefits	\$4,572,763	13.5	13.1
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$961,646	2.8	5.9
Special Education Tuition	\$7,979,884	23.6	21.8
Supplies	\$428,008	1.3	0.7
Property Services	\$106,389	0.3	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$3,375,044	10.0	8.1
Equipment	\$10,831	0.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$1,503	0.0	0.1
Total	\$33,857,029	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		23.6	24.9

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2021-22

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	33.1
State	53.1
Federal	12.8
Tuition & Other	1.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	71	72.5	71	68.8	39	73.1
Black or African American	502	56.8	501	49.5	238	50.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	2,548	58.8	2,532	52.8	1,023	52.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	196	65.0	195	59.8	82	54.4
White	958	69.8	952	64.6	422	63.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	877	54.2	870	50.4	346	46.9
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	3,403	63.4	3,386	57.0	1,461	57.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	3,403	59.2	3,380	53.2	1,438	53.1
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	877	70.5	876	65.0	369	63.4
Students with Disabilities	805	42.9	791	36.8	337	38.1
Students without Disabilities	3,475	65.8	3,465	59.9	1,470	59.2
High Needs	3,557	58.9	3,534	53.0	1,499	52.9
Non-High Needs	723	74.3	722	68.7	308	66.7
District	4,280	61.5	4,256	55.6	1,807	55.2

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	87.6	84.5	86.6	77.8	3,249	82.8
Curl Up	86.2	92.0	90.3	83.9	3,272	87.3
Push Up	72.5	64.5	67.3	63.4	3,266	66.2
Mile Run/PACER	82.7	63.5	46.7	44.3	3,260	56.0
All Tests - District	66.5	50.9	43.3	34.3	3,214	45.7
All Tests - State	51.5	46.0	44.1	41.1		45.5

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2021-22	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	80	82.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	357	84.9
White	156	90.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	89	73.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	502	85.5
Students with Disabilities	148	66.2
District	628	86.6
State		88.9

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2021-22 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	94.8	205	34.5
Male	*	135	22.2
Non-Binary	*	0	*
Black or African American	92.7	32	18.1
Hispanic or Latino	92.6	152	23.0
White	94.9	122	41.4
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	86.0	24	14.6
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	93.7	230	25.3
Students with Disabilities	77.7	*	*
District	93.3	340	28.2
State	95.2		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2022	Class of 2021
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	55.7	73.7
Male	41.5	75.0
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	45.9	74.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	43.0	65.3
White	55.8	82.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	32.4	81.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	45.8	69.2
Students with Disabilities	20.7	64.0
District	48.3	74.3
State	66.1	87.7

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	61.5	75	41.0	50	82.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	58.9	75	39.3	50	78.6	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	55.6	75	37.1	50	74.2	59.7
	High Needs Students	53.0	75	35.3	50	70.6	48.9
Science Performance Index	All Students	55.2	75	36.8	50	73.7	61.6
	High Needs Students	52.9	75	35.3	50	70.5	51.1
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	58.2%	100%	58.2	100	58.2	57.2%
	High Needs Students	57.7%	100%	57.7	100	57.7	52.5%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	58.7%	100%	58.7	100	58.7	61.8%
	High Needs Students	57.7%	100%	57.7	100	57.7	55.5%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	55.9%	100%	28.0	50	55.9	55.3%
	Oral	55.3%	100%	27.7	50	55.3	56.1%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	27.5%	<=5%	5.0	50	10.0	20.0%
	High Needs Students	30.5%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	28.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	94.9%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	90.4%
	% Meeting Benchmark	28.2%	75%	18.8	50	37.6	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		85.0%	94%	45.2	50	90.4	82.4%
4-year Graduation All Students (2022 Cohort)		86.6%	94%	92.2	100	92.2	88.9%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2020 Cohort)		88.1%	94%	93.7	100	93.7	85.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2022)		48.3%	75%	64.4	100	64.4	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		100.0% 45.7%	75%	30.5	50	60.9	93.0% 45.5%
Arts Access		65.2%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	54.5%
Accountability Index				962.3	1450	66.4	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	74.3	58.9	15.4	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	68.7	53.0	15.7	18.0	
Science Performance Index Gap	66.7	52.9	13.8	17.8	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	88.1%	5.9%	8.7%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	97.6
	High Needs Students	97.3
Math	All Students	97.1
	High Needs Students	96.7
Science	All Students	96.6
	High Needs Students	96.1

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 44.8

State: 49.6

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2022-23

Meriden School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Meriden Public Schools (MPS) has eight elementary schools, three middle schools, and two high schools. More than 77% of the district's student population of 8,500 students are eligible for free or reduced-priced meals, and 75% are students of color. Implementation of our District Improvement Plan has led to promoting student-centered learning environments across the district using blended learning, leading to greater choice and voice, critical thinking, creativity, and academic gains. Restorative practices at secondary schools have increased student voice. Elementary schools are also engaged in implementing restorative practices. In our 1:1 environment, students are provided district-issued devices to use with digital content in classes and to explore anytime, anywhere, learning beyond the classroom. Students keep their devices over the summer to access digital resources. High school students can enroll in online courses during the summer as well. Students may "check out" mobile hotspots if in need of Internet access.

School improvement plans include assessments conducted regularly throughout the school year. School-based data teams analyze data to identify areas where improvement is needed and areas where significant progress has been made. While School Improvement Plans are specific to school needs, they are aligned to the District Improvement Plan's goals in Talent, Academics, Climate, and Operations.

With the adoption of Connecticut's Common Core Standards, the district has embedded these standards into the district's English Language Arts-Literacy and Mathematics curriculum and implemented the NGSS in Science and the Connecticut Elementary and Secondary Social Studies Frameworks. The District Improvement Plan was recently revised by the District Leadership Team which meets monthly to review district academic, attendance, discipline, and school climate data. The Team monitors progress, provides feedback, and makes recommendations to our central office team.

With grant funding from a foundation, Meriden has developed a visual Portrait of a Graduate which was created through an Advisory Committee which includes community members, parents, students, administrators, and teachers. The Portrait consists of five attributes: I am a Learner, I am a Thinker, I am an Advocate, I am a Collaborator, I am Prepared for life after high school. Each attribute has corresponding indicators. Currently school based teams at the high schools are constructing multiple learning experiences - in school and in the community-that will allow all students to develop these competencies and ensure access to those opportunities is equitable and available to all students.

Efforts to engage our families include our Family School Liaison Team, which works to connect families to school supports, educates families on school and district expectations, makes home visits, and fosters school-community events. Community and Parent Learning. The district recently implemented ParentSquare district-wide. ParentSquare enables users to select from 100 languages to receive messages, allows teachers to use it for class-group messaging and one-to-one communication, and allows permission slips, automatic attendance, and more. MPS has a 99.1% contact ability across the district.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Meriden Public Schools believes that education is the great equalizer and provides a path to a better life for all students. The district continues to be proactive in combating systemic racism in our schools. We embrace the richness of our diversity, value our tapestry of different colors and cultures, and remain committed to addressing racial discrimination or unconscious bias. Meriden ensures all students have access to quality educational experiences and graduate college, career and life ready. Our long-standing commitment to equity is evident in initiatives implemented during the last decade. We have generated a series of Racial Equity Awareness training modules, created an Affinity Group for educators of color and other interested teachers. Most importantly, the district has recently hired a Director of Equity and Instruction to ensure equitable opportunities and access for all learners.

Our steps include a six-pronged approach: 1). Equity Leaders are continuing to roll out racial equity awareness training modules to high school teachers in small group settings to encourage conversations about the material presented; 2). Equity Leaders are expanding racial equity awareness training to middle and high school teachers using the same protocols; 3) Equity Leaders are presenting components of racial equity awareness training modules at our Board of Education meetings, Administrators' Meetings, Elementary and Secondary Principals' Meetings, and Administrators' Retreat; 4) office of Personnel and Talent Development continues to pursue recruitment and hiring of teachers of color in collaboration with Affinity Group; 5) The Office of Research and Evaluation continues to provide central office and board of education with Student Climate Survey data and trend analyses of student perception of racism in their school and community as well as disciplinary data disaggregated by students of color; and 6) A District Sub-Committee was established to ensure the advancement of equitable learning opportunities throughout the district. Under the leadership of the Director of Equity and Inclusion, Meriden's High School Equity Leaders are training two Equity Leaders in each of our eight elementary schools and three middle schools.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Meriden Board of Education takes great care to equitably allocate resources among the district's schools and programs based on the needs of individual buildings and district initiatives and to apply an equity lens to allocations. Resources for such areas as ongoing supplies and compensation for the errors inherent in enrollment projections are maintained. The Office of Teaching and Innovation maintains an emergency account that ensures all schools have necessary materials in cases where the building budget is unable to meet needs. The size of the building determines resource allocations for custodial supplies and manpower, and the age and condition of buildings are used to determine the priority list for major improvements and repairs.